Abhilash L R

Staff Engineer

Frontend engineering leader with 14 years of experience architecting scalable UI systems and managing high-performing teams. Started in the IE5 era and have continuously evolved with the web, now working at the intersection of frontend and AI-powered experiences.

+91 89397 37989
abhilashlr@outlook.com

Skills

Frontend Architect, NextJS, Typescript, Leader/Manager, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, EmberJS, ReactJS, NodeJS, ~~jQuery~~ and Github. Quite good at leading teams and mentoring junior folks. Has basic knowledge on AngularJS, Ruby on Rails, PHP, MySQL and Android.

Experience

Atomicwork (startup)

Founding Engineer (Frontend Architect)

OCT 2022 - PRESENT, CHENNAI, INDIA 🇮🇳

Founded and scaled the frontend team from the ground up, growing it from me being a solo and first frontend developer to a 10-member high-performing team. Owned hiring, onboarding, mentoring, and team structure.

Built the entire frontend architecture from scratch, establishing scalable design systems, code structure, and modular practices aligned with long-term product goals.

Set up and manage core engineering processes including code review workflows, CI/CD pipelines, release management, QA checklists, and issue triaging to ensure fast and stable deployments.

Led end-to-end feature delivery across multiple pods, working closely with product managers and designers to translate roadmap objectives into shippable software.

Drove technical excellence and performance, enforcing frontend best practices (lazy loading, bundle analysis, code splitting, accessibility), and introducing monitoring tools for real-time performance tracking.

Managed project timelines and priorities, balancing customer commitments with engineering bandwidth to ensure delivery without compromising on quality or maintainability.

Mentored engineers at various levels, holding regular monthly 1:1s focused on technical growth, career progression, and goal setting.

Fostered a culture of **collaboration, ownership, and continuous improvement**, aligning team values with company-wide goals and cross-functional outcomes.

Drivetrain (startup)

Staff Engineer (Frontend Architect)

APR 2021 - OCT 2022, REMOTE, INDIA 🇮🇳

Early founding team member (1 of 5), instrumental in scaling the engineering organization both in team size and technical capability during high-growth stages.

Established the frontend architecture from scratch, designing scalable and modular codebases, optimizing performance, and introducing robust patterns for long-term maintainability.

Led engineering best practices across the stack—enforcing code quality, modular design, lazy loading, and continuous performance monitoring to ensure a world-class user experience.

Mentored and coached 3 frontend engineers, conducting regular 1:1s to support technical growth, performance feedback, and career development planning.

Acted as a hands-on architect and technical leader, guiding implementation decisions, performing critical code reviews, and unblocking teams across feature delivery cycles.

Collaborated closely with product, design, and leadership to align engineering direction with business priorities, ensuring timely delivery without compromising code quality.

Played a key role in hiring, onboarding, and shaping the team's culture and engineering values as the company scaled.

Rocketlane (startup)

Lead frontend engineer

JUL 2020 - MAR 2021, CHENNAI, INDIA 🇮🇳

Joined as part of the **early 10-member founding engineering team**, leading frontend development for the customer onboarding product.

Led a team of 3 frontend engineers, providing architectural direction, setting code quality standards, and conducting regular code reviews to ensure scalable and maintainable solutions.

Collaborated closely with product and backend teams to deliver high-impact onboarding flows, improving customer experience and reducing time-to-value.

Introduced **frontend best practices** around performance optimization, modularization, and testing to support long-term product evolution. Researched tools and libraries like CKEditor, AGGrid and even the framework for that matter.

Freshworks (formerly Freshdesk)

Lead frontend engineer (Freshsales, Freshdesk, Freddy, and Freshteam)

FEB 2015 - JUN 2018 & FEB 2019 - JUL 2020, CHENNAI, INDIA 🇮🇳

Promoted from UI Developer to Lead Frontend Engineer, taking ownership of feature architecture and delivery across key products including **Freshsales, Freshdesk, Freshteam**, and **Freddy (AI assistant)**.

Led a frontend tribe of 5 engineers, mentoring junior developers, conducting code reviews, and establishing best practices for scalable and maintainable UI development.

Worked **cross-functionally across multiple product teams**, contributing to frontend features in **Freshchat, Freshcaller, and Freshservice**, ensuring design consistency and shared component reuse.

Played a key role in **building and evolving Freshteam**, and was formally mentored to take on **frontend team management responsibilities** within that product line.

Championed performance improvements, UI consistency, and quality-first engineering culture across teams.

Cognizant Technology Solutions Pvt. Ltd.
Frontend Developer
OCT 2011 - SEP 2014, CHENNAI, INDIA 🇮🇳

Joined as Programmer Analyst Trainee and then promoted as Programmer Analyst. Worked across multiple verticals like Banking, Life Science, Hospitality, etc.

Side projects

Chennai Commute
SEP 2014 - JUN 2016, CHENNAI, INDIA 🇮🇳

Built an End to End Web + Android app as a side project based on Google transit.

Education

Anna University
B.E, Electronics & Comm. Eng.
2007 - 2011, CHENNAI, INDIA 🇮🇳

- Graduated from Tagore Engineering College (Anna University affiliated) with First class distinction of 75% GPA.
- Chairman for the Electronics and Communication Engineering during 2010-2011.